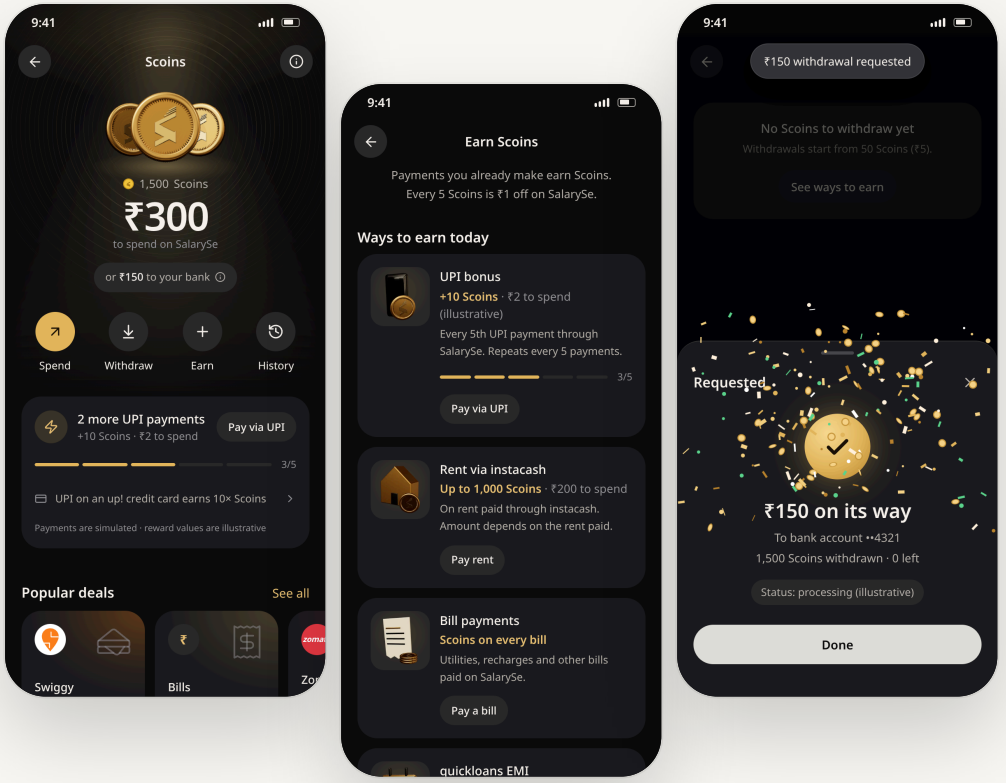
SalarySe · Product design challenge

Make Scoins feel like money

Design decisions behind the Scoins wallet, the Earn experience and the redemption flows: what each screen says, and why it says it that way.

The lever: 5 Scoins = ₹1 spent on SalarySe, 10 Scoins = ₹1 to bank. Spending in-app is worth 2×, and almost nobody knew.

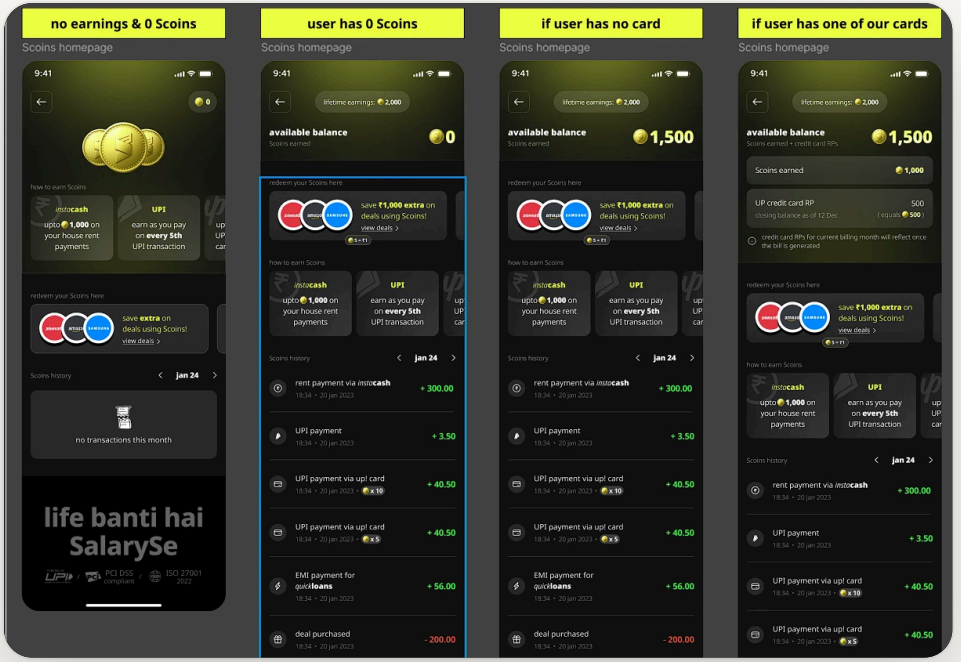
The answer: lead with rupees, make the better rate the default without hiding the other, and give every state a next step.



Interactive prototype: claude.ai/artifact/VrxVM3azJxau7ZQbx6ibTs · All earn amounts, deals and card figures are illustrative.

Why Scoins feel useless today

A Scoin balance is a number with no meaning. The wallet never says what 1,500 Scoins are worth, offers no Spend, Withdraw or Earn action, and leaves a zero balance as a decorative coin over an empty list. The one fact that would change behaviour, that Scoins are worth 2× inside SalarySe, appears only in a cash-out popup with guilt copy, after the user has decided to leave.



Before: the current wallet across its four states.

What I found beyond the brief

- **History looks like rupees.** `+300.00` with no unit reads as ₹300 arriving. Fractional Scoins make it worse.
- **Redeeming is drawn as a loss.** A red minus on the action we want most.
- **The balance doesn't reconcile.** Lifetime 2,000, available 0, nothing in between.
- **Cardholders get a third currency**, with pending and available blended.
- **Earning is tied to credit products**, so mechanics must reward paying on time, never borrowing.
- **Deals ignore the balance.** "Save ₹1,000" even at zero.

What I fixed first

1. **Trust:** every amount carries its unit and ₹ value; the ledger reconciles.
2. **Rupee-first value** with the bank value beside it.
3. **A next step in every state.**

Six principles, and the order they put the wallet in

Principles

1. **Lead with rupees.** The in-app ₹ value is the headline.
2. **Show both rates, rank them.** 5 = ₹1 is primary; 10 = ₹1 is always visible, never guilt-framed.
3. **Every amount carries its unit.** No bare numbers, no decimals on Scoins.
4. **Spending is saving.** "Saved ₹50", not a red minus.
5. **The balance always reconciles.** Running balance; pending never mixed into available.
6. **One next step per state.**

Wallet order, top to bottom

1. **Balance**: what do I have, in rupees?
2. **Actions**: Spend, Withdraw, Earn, History.
3. **Card rewards** (cardholders): where the balance came from.
4. **Next reward**: the earning habit, kept high.
5. **Popular deals**: concrete ways to spend.
6. **Value calculator**: exploration, below the decisions.
7. **Recent activity**: the record, last.

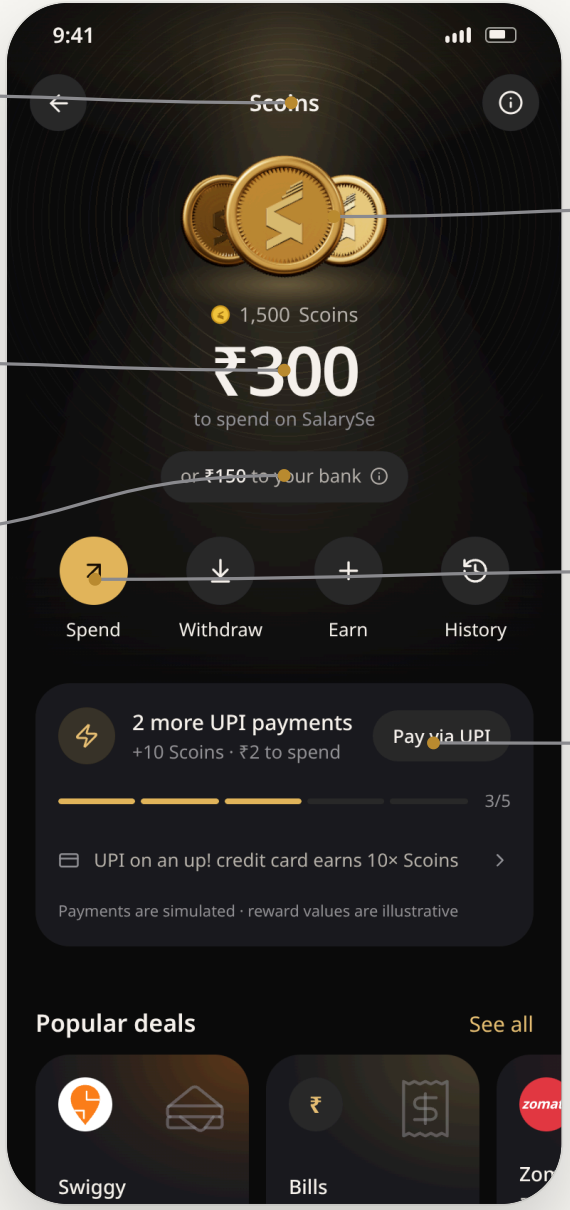
Merged: a "Rates" action duplicated the pill and the ⓘ button, so it became History. The value card duplicated the calculator, so it was removed.

Rupees first, with the better choice as the default

Light falls from above: one soft beam and engraved rings, faded before the cards begin

Lead with the money: ₹300 is the headline, Scoins sit above it as the unit

Keep the alternative visible. Bank value lives in one pill, a tap from the rate explainer



Real 3D coins: drag to spin, tap to flip. They never cover the number

Four identical actions. Only Spend is gold: the 2× choice is the default

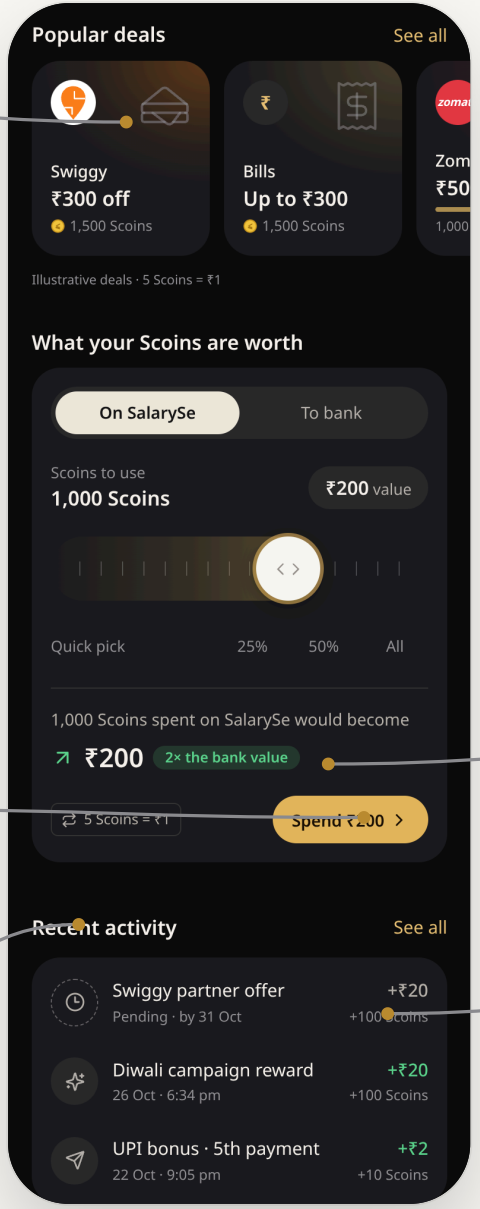
One row says what to do next, what it is worth and how close you are

Every explanation ends in an action

Deals ranked by what the balance covers. Out-of-reach ones say how many more Scoins

Calculator ends in a button that carries the amount into the flow

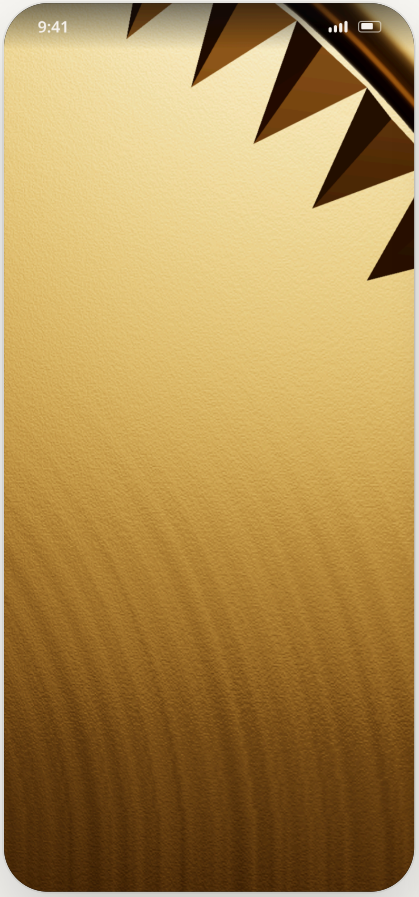
Section order follows intent: earn, then spend, then explore, then the record



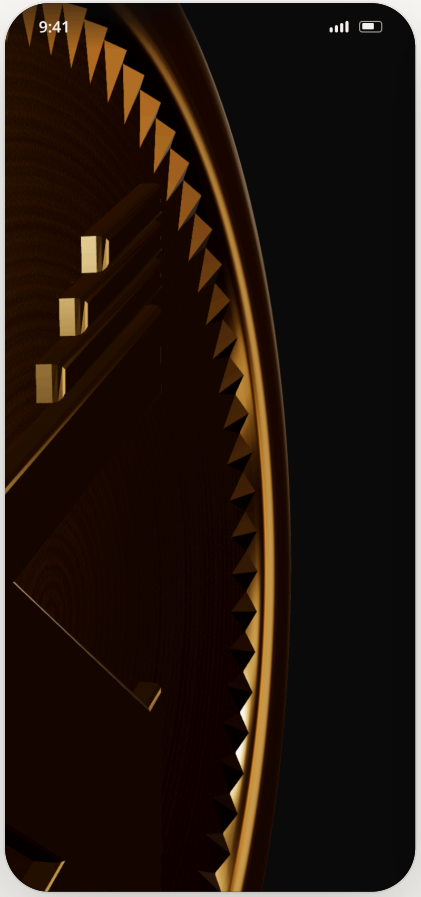
2× is a calm badge, not a warning. Bank mode shows the in-app value as information

Rupees lead, Scoins follow. Redemptions read "Saved ₹50", never a red minus

A short, real 3D moment that ends in the balance



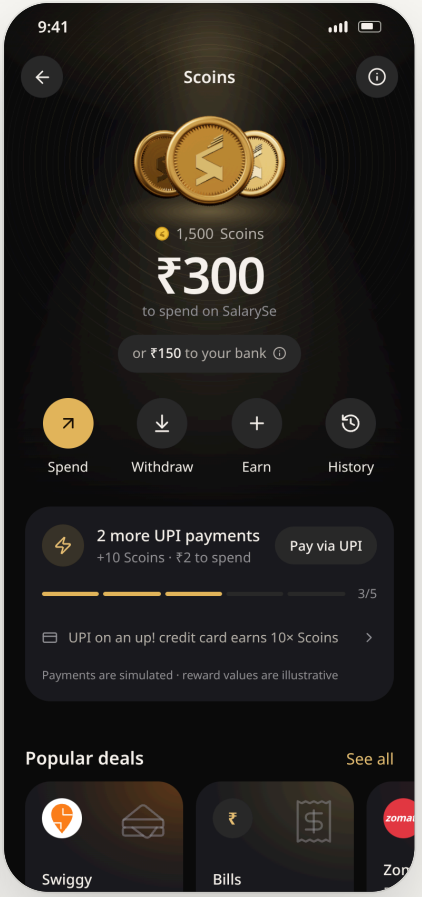
0.0s · Close-up
The camera starts on the embossed S and pulls back in one continuous move.



0.7s · Edge-on
A full turn shows real thickness and the reeded edge. Real geometry, not a flat image.

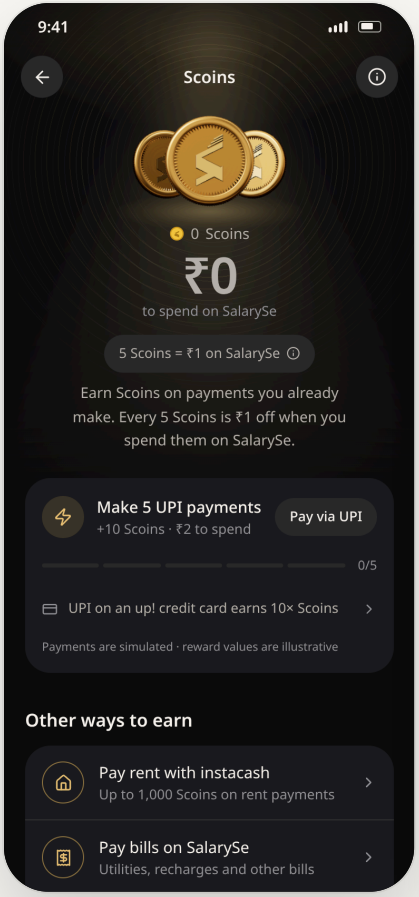


1.9s · Formation
Two coins slide out from behind into the overlap from the reference sheet.



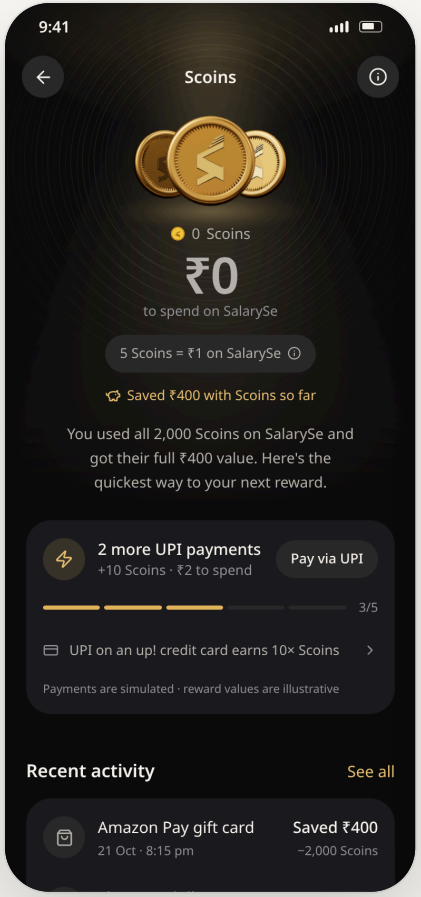
3.0s · Wallet
One GSAP timeline lands the coins and reveals the UI. Plays once; shorter on repeat; static with reduced motion.

Each state gets its own message and next step



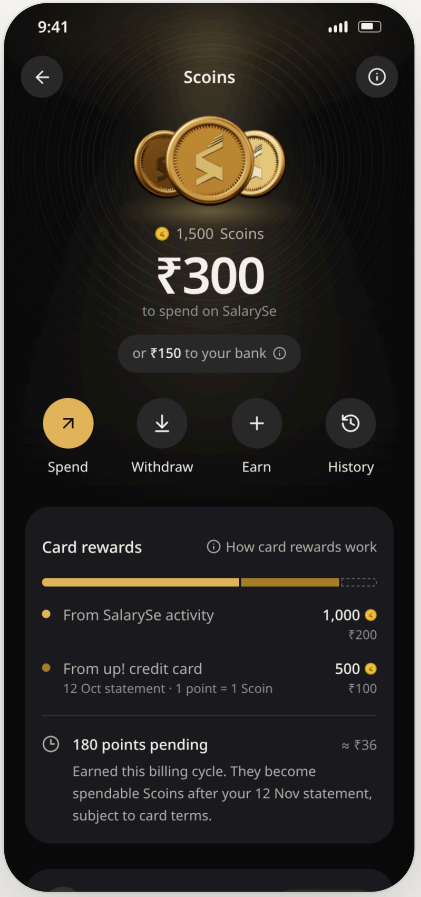
New user

Explains what Scoins are worth and starts a first reward (0 of 5). No empty history.



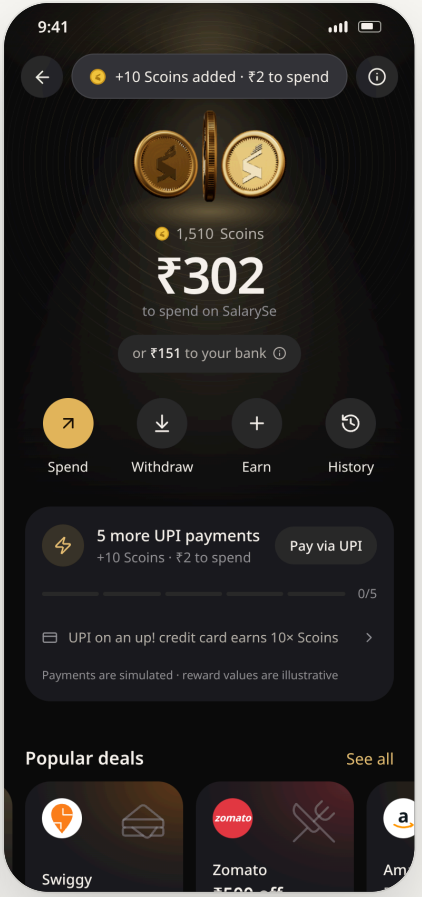
Spent everything

“Saved ₹400 with Scoins so far” turns zero into proof of value, then points to the next reward.



Cardholder

Balance split by source, with pending card points and when they become spendable.



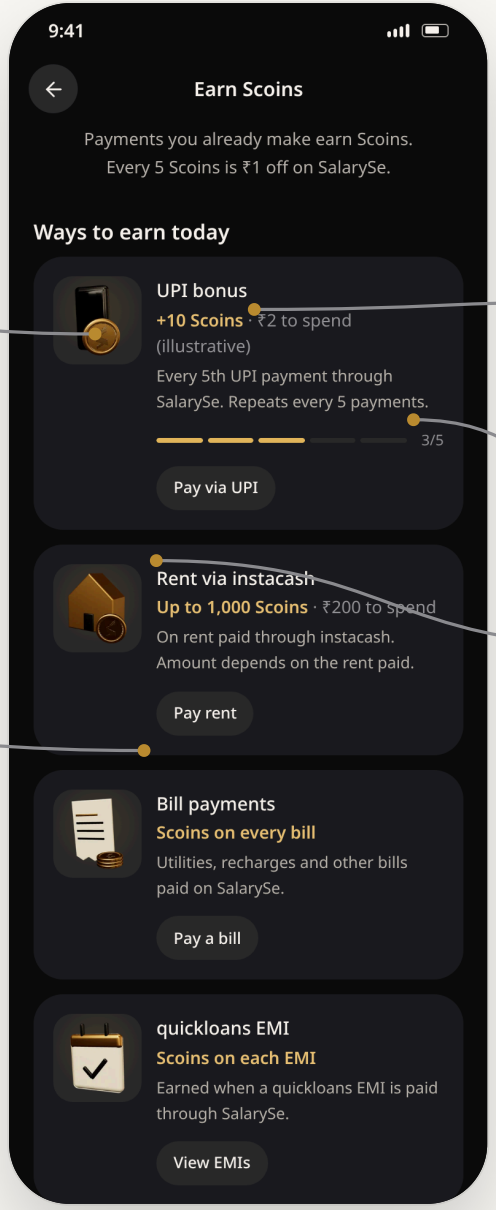
Reward lands

The coin turns, the balance counts up and a toast confirms “+10 Scoins · ₹2 to spend”.

Show what earns, how much, and the next step

Illustrations rendered in the Scoin's own gold so the screen feels like one world

Real product rules only. Anything we do not know stays unstated



Every card answers: the action, the Scoins and their ₹ value, the limits, the next step

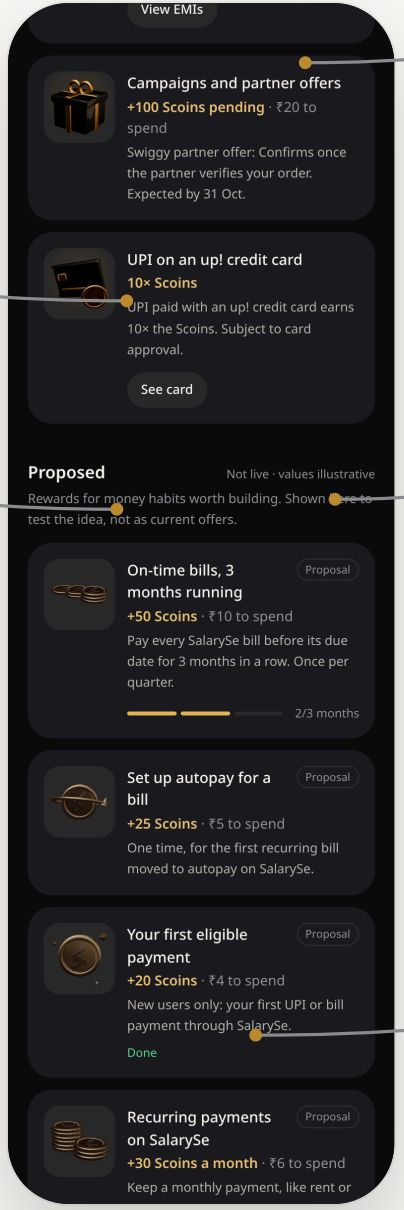
Progress only where a rule has one

One button per card, and it does one thing

Propose habits worth rewarding, and label them as proposals

Card benefit is one line for non-holders. The wallet is not an ad

Reward punctuality and recurring habits, never borrowing or spending more

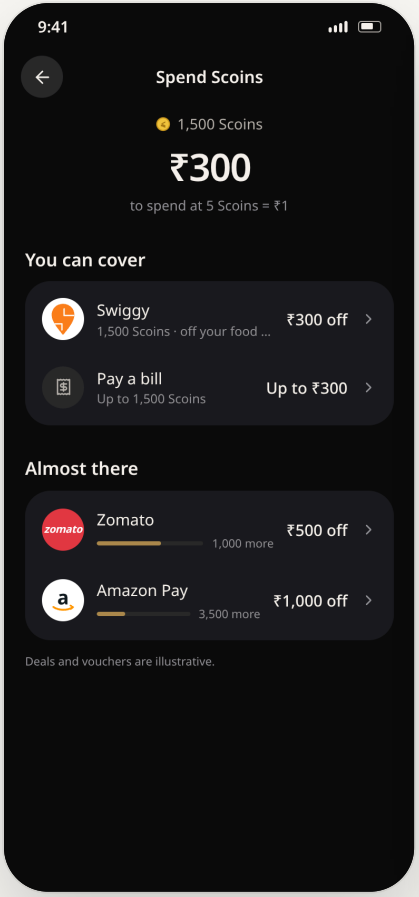


Campaigns show a pending reward or "Notify me", never an empty slot

Proposals are marked, greyed and illustrative, so nothing reads as a live offer

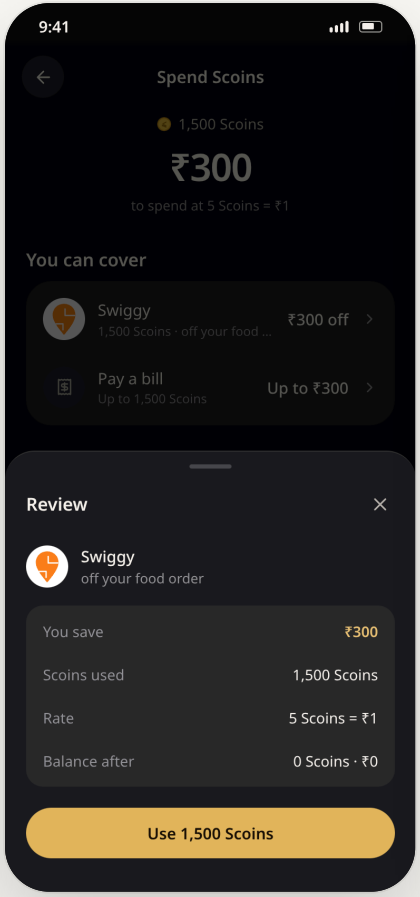
Caps and one-time rewards stop gaming

Review exactly what it costs and saves, then celebrate



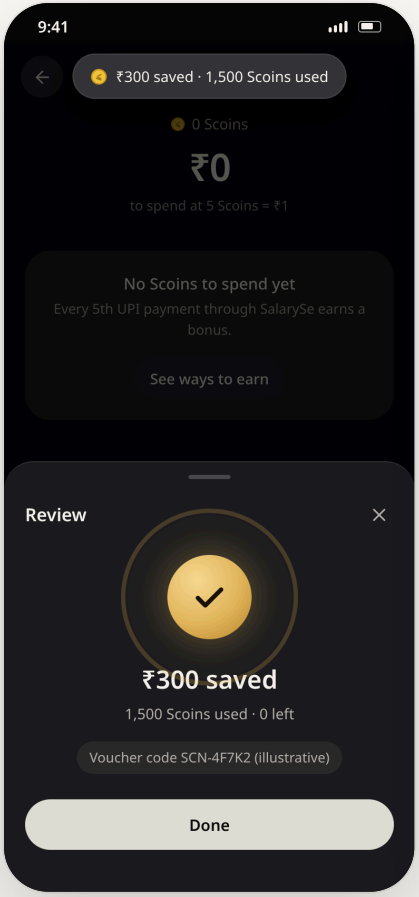
Choose

“You can cover” first, “Almost there” second, each with the Scoins still needed.



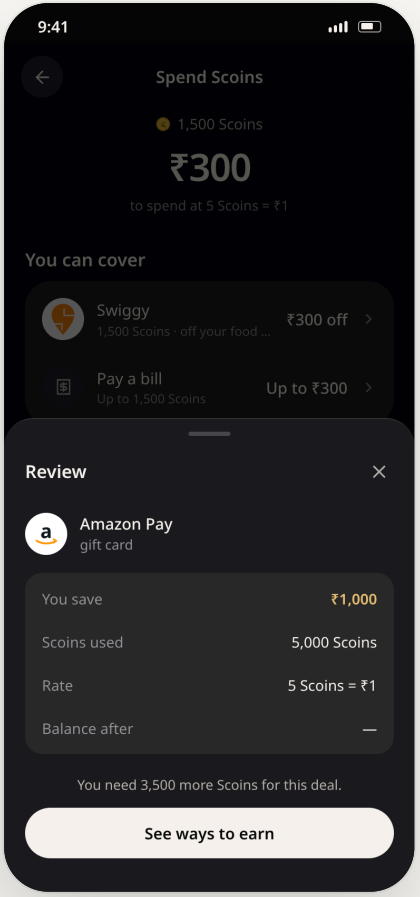
Review

You save, Scoins used, the rate and the balance after. One button names the exact cost.



Success

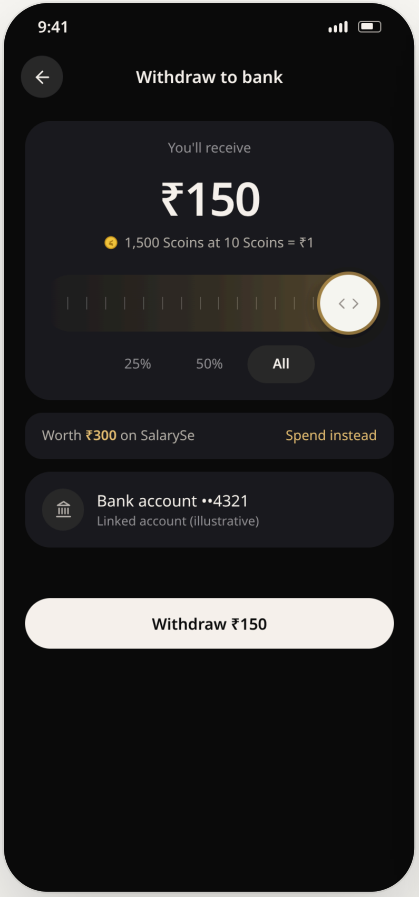
The exact saving, the Scoins used and what is left, with the voucher or bill outcome.



Not enough Scoins

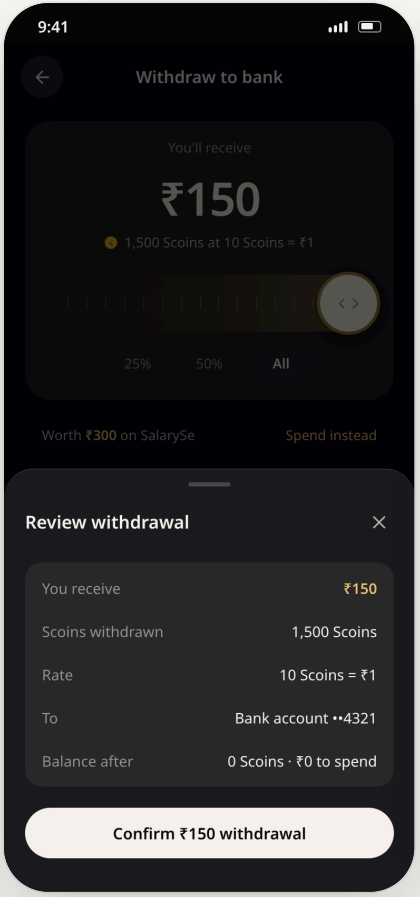
Says exactly how many more are needed and offers a way to earn, not a dead button.

Cash out without guilt, and without hiding the better rate



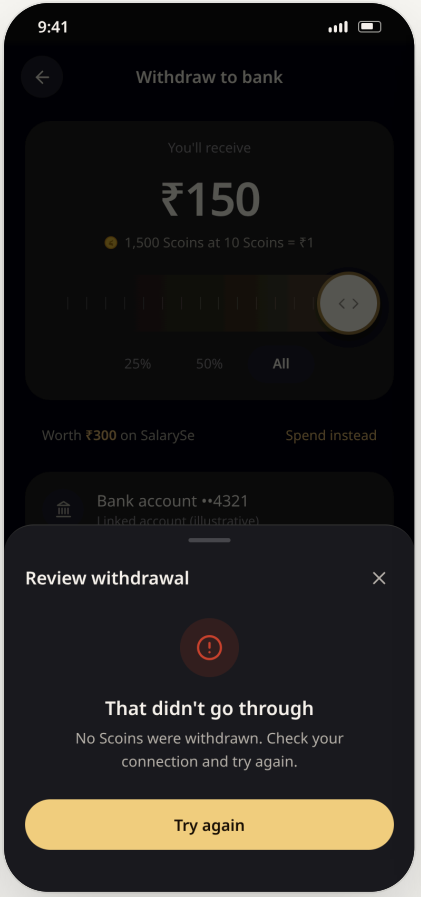
Amount

"You'll receive ₹150" at 10 = ₹1, with "Worth ₹300 on SalarySe" as information.



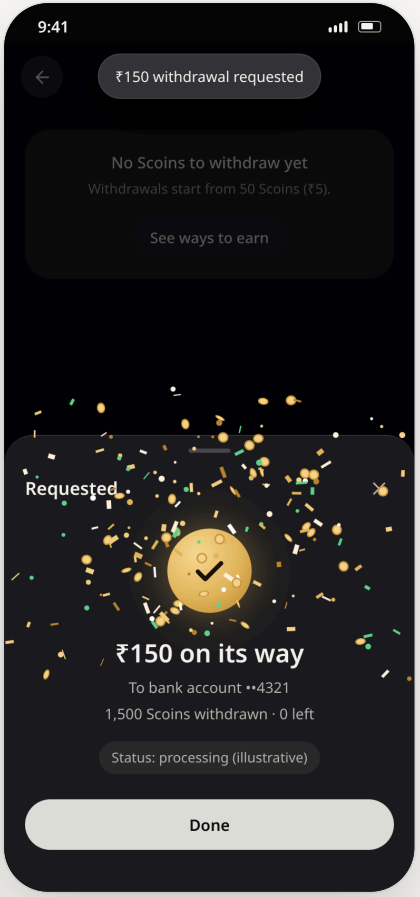
Review

Every figure before confirming: rupees, Scoins, rate, account, balance after.



Error

Plain words, what did not happen ("No Scoins were withdrawn") and one way forward.



Requested

Badge springs in, tick draws, confetti and gold coins burst, the amount counts up. Repeats the exact amount and account.

Each mechanic, the behaviour it drives and the value it creates

Mechanic	Behaviour it encourages	Value to the user	How we'd measure it
Rupee-first balance	Planning with Scoins as money	Understands worth in seconds	Correct ₹ value in tests; wallet → Spend taps
Both rates, “2× the bank value”	Choosing to spend in-app	Twice the value	% of Scoins spent in-app
UPI progress tracker (3 of 5)	Repeat eligible UPI payments	A short, clear path to a reward	Bonus completion; UPI per user per cycle
Deals ranked by what the balance covers	A first redemption; saving toward a deal	No doubt about “is it enough?”	First-redemption rate; time to first
“Saved ₹400”, lifetime saved	Redeeming again	Spending feels like gaining	Redemptions per active user
Calculator → Spend / Withdraw with amount	Turning curiosity into action	Fewer steps	Calculator → redemption conversion
Celebration on earn and redeem	Noticing and repeating the action	Confirmation it landed	Repeat earning next cycle
Pending vs available card points	Using the card without confusion	No surprise about points	Support contacts on points
Neutral withdrawal	Withdrawing only when cash is needed	Free choice, no guilt	Withdrawal share; complaints
On-time bills, 3 months Proposal	Paying before the due date	Avoids late fees	On-time payment rate
Autopay setup Proposal	Moving recurring bills to autopay	Never misses a bill	Autopay adoption; 90-day retention
First eligible payment Proposal	Activation	Immediate value	D7 activation
Recurring payments, capped at 3 Proposal	Keeping monthly payments on SalarySe	Rewards for what they already pay	Recurring payers per month

Reward good money habits, never more borrowing

Guardrails

- No mechanic rewards borrowing more or spending more for its own sake.
- Streaks reward punctuality, never volume.
- Caps stop gaming: the UPI bonus resets every 5 payments; recurring payments cap at 3.
- Withdrawing is always available and never framed as a loss.
- Every illustrative value is labelled. The two rates are fixed everywhere.

Accessibility and motion

- Reduced motion: the intro, beam, confetti and celebrations become calm static states.
- One screen-reader announcement once the calculator settles, not one per drag step.
- 44px touch targets; keyboard support for the slider and the coins.

What I'd test first

1. Five-second test: “What are your Scoins worth?” Before vs after.
2. First-redemption rate with deals ranked by coverage vs a generic list.
3. In-app share of Scoins with the side-by-side rates vs the cash-out popup.

Open questions for SalarySe

- Real earn rates per bill and EMI, and whether Scoins expire.
- Minimum withdrawal and payout timing.
- Partner list and whether deals cover all or part of the price.